Part – A Case Study

UPI "Receive Money" Fraud

The Crime: UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud involves scammers manipulating people into unknowingly authorizing outgoing payments under the false pretense of receiving money, getting a refund and claiming a prize.

How it Happens:

1. The Setup: A college student lists an item like a used textbook, bicycle, or phone on an online marketplace like an unauthorized web page .
2. The Hook: A scammer contacts the student, expressing immediate interest. They agree to the asking price without much negotiation to build excitement and trust.
3. The Trap**:** The scammer insists on paying immediately via UPI . However, instead of sending funds, the scammer sends a "Payment Request" link or a QR code to the student.
4. The Manipulation**:** The scammer pressures the student on a phone call, creating urgency. They falsely claim the student must scan the QR code or enter their 4-digit/6-digit UPI PIN to authorize the deposit into their account.
5. The Theft**:** The moment the student enters their UPI PIN, the agreed-upon amount is instantly deducted from their bank account and transferred to the scammer.

Who is Targeted**:** College students, young adults selling items online, and individuals who are familiar with using UPI but may not fully understand the technical mechanics of payment requests.

The Consequences: Victims suffer immediate financial loss, which is often difficult to recover once the money leaves the bank network. Beyond the money loss, it causes immense stress, anxiety, and a loss of confidence in digital transactions.